

THE MOVE

D — Describe: name the observable behaviour. "In the last two meetings, the decision changed after we'd already agreed the scope." -> **E — Express:** name the effect, not the motive. "That makes it hard to plan the work and keep the team ?

START HERE

When [specific behaviour] happens, it affects [impact]. I need [specific change]. If that can't happen, I'll [clear next step].

SAY THIS

Minimum viable move	<i>"When that keeps happening, it affects the work. I need one clear change. If it can't happen, I'll take the next step myself."</i>
Warm and collaborative	<i>"I'm raising this because I want us to work well together."</i>
Work and meetings	<i>"When the draft comes in after the review window, I can't give it proper attention. I need it by Tuesday noon. If it's later, it moves to the next review cycle."</i>
Clear ask and bound...	<i>"Please let me finish the timeline before challenging it."</i>
Soften and recover	<i>"That came out sharper than I intended — I'm not threatening you, I'm being clear about what I can and can't do."</i>
Pressure and pushba...	<i>"You can absolutely challenge it — I'm asking for sequencing, not silence. Finish first, challenge second."</i>

AVOID

- There is immediate danger, harassment or a crisis — use formal support, documentation or safety planning
- A power imbalance means a private, direct conversation could increase harm
- You cannot yet name the behaviour specifically

REMEMBER

Make the C about your boundary, not their punishment.